

Scripture for waiting on test results

Nothing to do, no news, every phone call a possible verdict. Waiting is its own kind of hard, and most verses people send are secretly about the news being good. These five are not. They are for the person by the phone, and they were written by people who then got the news, good and bad. Fold this and keep it in a pocket.

THE NIGHT BEFORE

Habakkuk 3:17-18

“For though the fig tree doesn’t flourish, nor fruit be in the vines; the labor of the olive fails, the fields yield no food; the flocks are cut off from the fold, and there is no herd in the stalls: yet I will rejoice in Yahweh. I will be joyful in the God of my salvation!”

Though the fig tree doesn't flourish, yet I will rejoice. The Bible's clearest trust that doesn't depend on the news being good. Say it before the call, so it's already said.

Psalms 4:8

“In peace I will both lay myself down and sleep, for you, Yahweh alone, make me live in safety.”

For sleep. Someone else is on watch.

THE MORNING OF

Psalms 112:7

“He will not be afraid of evil news. His heart is steadfast, trusting in Yahweh.”

A heart steady before the news, not after it. The only steadiness available while the phone hasn't rung.

Isaiah 41:10

“Don’t you be afraid, for I am with you. Don’t be dismayed, for I am your God. I will strengthen you. Yes, I will help you. Yes, I will uphold you with the right hand of my righteousness.”

Five promises, and a hand. The verse doesn't describe the news. It describes the company.

EVERY TIME THE MIND RUNS AHEAD

Matthew 6:34

“Therefore don’t be anxious for tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious for itself. Each day’s own evil is sufficient.”

Tomorrow will worry about itself. Today, the whole assignment is waiting. That is enough.

WHAT TO SAY

- “I know you’re waiting. I’m not going to ask. I’m just here.”
- “Whatever it is, you won’t hear it alone. Call me right after.”
- Offer to sit with them the night before, or to be there when the call comes.

WHAT NOT TO SAY

- × “I’m sure it’s nothing.” You don’t know that, and they know you don’t.

HOW TO USE THIS

Pick one for the night before and one for the morning. Say them out loud. When the mind runs to tomorrow, name today’s one task, which is waiting, and come back to it. It’s a practice, not a switch.